



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	19 th February 2026	Time of Incident	11:00
Directorate / Region	RMO - Wheatbelt	Main Roads or Contractor	Main Roads WA
EQSafe Event Type	Injury/ Illness	EQSafe Incident Number	56906
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Worker Experiences pain in arm while disconnecting hydraulic hose
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Executive Summary

On the morning of the 19th of February, a Maintenance crew including the Injured Person (IP) were conducting a pavement repair at a site located approximately 80kms east of Northam.

After the second profiling activity was completed, the skidsteer was reversed off the patch area. The IP then used the petrol-powered blower to clean the surrounding area.

When the IP had completed cleaning the area, they approached the skidsteer, where they grasped the hydraulic block connection with their left hand (while wearing gloves). As this occurred, the IP reported feeling a sensation, which they stated resembled that of an electric shock, move through their arm. The IP released their grip on the connection block.



Re-enactment photo of the position of the IP's hands

The Leading Hand continued to offload the mill and attach the skid steer bucket. While the Leading Hand completed this task, the IP and a colleague discussed what had occurred. After approximately 15 mins, the Leading Hand returned to the work area, and the IP reported the occurrence.

The skidsteer was shut down immediately and the incident was reported to the regional safety team.

The IP was escorted to the local hospital where they were diagnosed as having sustained an electric shock and declared unfit for work for 1 day.

On the morning of 20th February, an Auto-electrician was engaged to conduct tests on the skidsteer and mill attachment.

Findings

- The Auto-electrician's report confirms that there was no transient voltage leak through any part of the body earth system back from EMF or other source.
- Based on the information provided in the auto-electricians report and research conducted, it is assumed that the "shock" sensation was potentially that of a static build up because of the flow of hydraulic fluid. Alternatively, it may have also been felt because of nerve or ligament strain.
- The IP was wearing their gloves at the time of the incident.
- No previous incidents of "electric shock" sensations had been reported.
- The skid steer and mill undergo a regular maintenance program.
- There were no underground services in the area.

Corrective Actions

- Skid steer and Mill were tested by an Auto-electrician to determine if an electrical leakage existed.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Ensure that all plant and equipment undergo a maintenance program in accordance with manufacturers specifications.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations